

FRUIT OF THE SPIRIT

TEXT: [Galatians 5:22-26](#) (NKJV) ***“But the fruit of the Spirit is love, joy, peace, longsuffering, kindness, goodness, faithfulness,²³ gentleness, self-control. Against such there is no law.²⁴ And those who are Christ’s have crucified the flesh with its passions and desires.²⁵ If we live in the Spirit, let us also walk in the Spirit.²⁶ Let us not become conceited, provoking one another, envying one another.”***

INTRO I am thoroughly convinced that it is the will of God for every believer to walk in the fullness of the Spirit. [Jesus informed His disciples that the main reason for His departure from planet earth was to make room for the work of the Spirit in their lives.](#) [John 16:7](#) (KJV) ***“Nevertheless I tell you the truth; It is expedient for you that I go away: for if I go not away, the Comforter will not come unto you; but if I depart, I will send him unto you.”*** If the work of the Holy Spirit was important enough for Jesus to tell His disciples that His reason for leaving them was so the Spirit could do His work, then it goes without saying that all believers should have this Spirit in operation within.

Many people desire to have the Holy Spirit at work within, but they do not believe they are worthy of such a work. It is imperative that each believer understand that because of the work Jesus finished on the cross, we stand before God accepted and approved, we are looked after and cared for by God. Because of this, [the believer becomes the recipient of abundant as well as eternal life!](#) [Ephesians 1:3-7](#) (NLT) ***“How we praise God, the Father of our Lord Jesus Christ, who has blessed us with every spiritual blessing in the heavenly realms because we belong to Christ. 4 Long ago, even before he made the world, God loved us and chose us in Christ to be holy and without fault in his eyes. 5 His unchanging plan has always been to adopt us into his own family by bringing us to himself through Jesus Christ. And this gave him great pleasure.”***

Let us all understand that the believer is not accepted by God because he deserves it, or because he has kept enough laws to win the approval of God! The believer has been accepted, and possesses the approval of God because of the person and sacrifice of the Lord Jesus Christ alone!

Because we have been loved into the Kingdom through Jesus, we do not need to live our life under bondage to the past. [Romans 8:1-18](#) (NLT) ***“So***

now there is no condemnation for those who belong to Christ Jesus. 2 For the power of the life-giving Spirit has freed you through Christ Jesus from the power of sin that leads to death. 3 The law of Moses could not save us, because of our sinful nature. But God put into effect a different plan to save us. He sent his own Son in a human body like ours, except that ours are sinful. God destroyed sin's control over us by giving his Son as a sacrifice for our sins. 4 He did this so that the requirement of the law would be fully accomplished for us who no longer follow our sinful nature but instead follow the Spirit. 5 Those who are dominated by the sinful nature think about sinful things, but those who are controlled by the Holy Spirit think about things that please the Spirit. 6 If your sinful nature controls your mind, there is death. But if the Holy Spirit controls your mind, there is life and peace. 7 For the sinful nature is always hostile to God. It never did obey God's laws, and it never will. 8 That's why those who are still under the control of their sinful nature can never please God. 9 But you are not controlled by your sinful nature. You are controlled by the Spirit if you have the Spirit of God living in you. (And remember that those who do not have the Spirit of Christ living in them are not Christians at all.) 10 Since Christ lives within you, even though your body will die because of sin, your spirit is alive because you have been made right with God. 11 The Spirit of God, who raised Jesus from the dead, lives in you. And just as he raised Christ from the dead, he will give life to your mortal body by this same Spirit living within you. 12 So, dear brothers and sisters, you have no obligation whatsoever to do what your sinful nature urges you to do. 13 For if you keep on following it, you will perish. But if through the power of the Holy Spirit you turn from it and its evil deeds, you will live. 14 For all who are led by the Spirit of God are children of God. 15 So you should not be like cowering, fearful slaves. You should behave instead like God's very own children, adopted into his family—calling him "Father, dear Father." 16 For his Holy Spirit speaks to us deep in our hearts and tells us that we are God's children. 17 And since we are his children, we will share his treasures—for everything God gives to his Son, Christ, is ours, too. But if we are to share his glory, we must also share his suffering. 18 Yet what we suffer now is nothing compared to the glory he will give us later."

The believer does not stand approved and accepted before God because he has kept enough laws and has earned the right to stand there! He is there because:

- He has placed his faith in Jesus Christ...

- His Faith honors the Son of God...
- God loves his Son so much that he honors anyone who believes in his Son...
- God honors the believer by doing exactly what his Faith can expect...

Each believer is approved and accepted of God but when the faith of the believer can embrace where it stands before God, the faith and the works of the believer begins to take on a new way of life.

The point is this: **Our primary identity is, we are Sons of God** and as such we are completely within our rights to enjoy all the privileges and blessings that son-ship affords.

Some would ask, does this mean that the believer has no restraint upon his life and behavior? That he is free to live as he wishes? That he is free to follow the desires and lusts of the flesh? To seek the things of the world, and give in to the urges to look, think, touch, taste, and do as he pleases?

The answer is no! A thousand times no! **The true believer** who has accepted the nature of God **has taken on the characteristics and attributes of his Heavenly Father!** (He becomes just like his daddy!) **2 Peter 1:4 (KJV)** *"Whereby are given unto us exceeding great and precious promises: that by these ye might be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust." **Ephesians 4:24 (KJV)** *"...Put on the new man, which after God is created in righteousness and true holiness." **Colossians 3:10 (KJV)** *"... Put on the new man, which is renewed in knowledge after the image of him that created him:"* **1 Corinthians 6:19-20 (KJV)** *"What? Know ye not that your body is the temple of the Holy Ghost which is in you, which ye have of God, and ye are not your own? {20} For ye are bought with a price: therefore glorify God in your body, and in your spirit, which are God's."***

God will have absolutely nothing to do with sin! In fact the Word say's **Psalms 66:18 (KJV)** *"If I regard iniquity in my heart, the Lord will not hear me."*

The very nature of God prevents Him from associating with sin! As believers, if His nature is in us it will not allow us to continue in sin either. **Romans 6:1-16 (NLT)** *"Well then, should we keep on sinning so that God can show us more and more kindness and forgiveness? 2 Of course not!*

Since we have died to sin, how can we continue to live in it? 3 Or have you forgotten that when we became Christians and were baptized to become one with Christ Jesus, we died with him? 4 For we died and were buried with Christ by baptism. And just as Christ was raised from the dead by the glorious power of the Father, now we also may live new lives. 5 Since we have been united with him in his death, we will also be raised as he was. 6 Our old sinful selves were crucified with Christ so that sin might lose its power in our lives. We are no longer slaves to sin. 7 For when we died with Christ we were set free from the power of sin. 8 And since we died with Christ, we know we will also share his new life. 9 We are sure of this because Christ rose from the dead, and he will never die again. Death no longer has any power over him. 10 He died once to defeat sin, and now he lives for the glory of God. 11 So you should consider yourselves dead to sin and able to live for the glory of God through Christ Jesus. 12 Do not let sin control the way you live; do not give in to its lustful desires. 13 Do not let any part of your body become a tool of wickedness, to be used for sinning. Instead, give yourselves completely to God since you have been given new life. And use your whole body as a tool to do what is right for the glory of God. 14 Sin is no longer your master, for you are no longer subject to the law, which enslaves you to sin. Instead, you are free by God's grace. 15 So since God's grace has set us free from the law, does this mean we can go on sinning? Of course not! 16 Don't you realize that whatever you choose to obey becomes your master? You can choose sin, which leads to death, or you can choose to obey God and receive his approval."

This passage of scripture points out the following:

- The believer is not to use their new found freedom as an opportunity to sin...
- The believer is dead to sin, and all its attractions...
- The believer experiences new life through their faith in Jesus Christ...
- The old sinful nature of the believer has been crucified to the cross of Christ...
- The believer is no longer a slave to sin...
- Sin is powerless in the life of the believer...
- The believer shares in new life through Christ...
- The new life of the believer is to bring glory to God...
- The believer is the only one who can determine whether he will live victoriously... Vs. 12, "Do not let..." "Do not give into..." Vs. 13, "Do not let..." "Give yourselves completely..." "Use your whole

body... Vs. 14, *“Sin IS no longer your master...”*

- The believer is free by the grace of God...
- The choices believers makes determines whether they are free or not...

(END OF WORKSHEET #1)

If the believer walks in the liberty which God intends him to, he will bear the fruit of Gods nature, which we refer to as the fruit of the Spirit.

In our text the word fruit is singular not plural. The Holy Spirit does not have many fruits, it has one fruit.

ILLUSTRATION: An apple consists of:

- A stem...
- A peeling...
- The meat...
- The core...
- The seed...

(Have five people come to the front and place one of these components in each persons hand then ask which of these people have an apple in their possession? The answer is that none of them is in possession of an apple)

If a person has only one or two of the components of the Fruit of the Spirit, they are not in possession of the fruit! It is all or none!

The fruit of the Spirit is broken down into a list of traits:

- Love...
- Joy...
- Peace...
- Long-suffering...
- Gentleness...
- Goodness...
- Faith...
- Meekness...
- Temperance...

Remember the Holy Spirit has only one nature, one fruit, therefore, when

He lives within a person, all these traits will be present! These components are not gifts, they are the fruit or outgrowth of a life lived in the Spirit. An apple tree does not have to be trained to grow apples; it grows apples because it is an apple tree. The Christian does not produce this fruit because he has kept a list of rules he produces this fruit because he is a believer which is walking with God in accordance with His Word.

The genuine believer does not pick and choose which components of the fruit of the spirit he or she will allow to be at work in their life. Each believer should possess each and every one of these characteristic traits in his or her life!

I. THE COMPONENT OF LOVE...

The word love as it is used here has reference to agape love which is a love of the mind, reason, and the will! Agape love is a love that goes so far that it loves regardless of feelings. Agape love:

- Causes a person to offer love whether they feel like it or not...
- Causes a person to love people who do not deserve to be loved...
- Causes a person to love people who reject love...

Agape love is the kind of love Jesus demonstrated when He looked beyond our fault and saw our need. Look at four significant points concerning agape love:

- Agape love is selfless love and is the very kind of love possessed by God Himself... John 3:16 (NKJV) ***"For God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son, that whoever believes in Him should not perish but have everlasting life."***
- Agape love is the love demonstrated through the cross of Christ... John 15:13 (KJV) ***"Greater love hath no man than this, that a man lay down his life for his friends."***
- Agape love is the love God demonstrated for the ungodly... Romans 5:6-8 (NKJV) ***"For when we were still without strength, in due time Christ died for the ungodly. 7 For scarcely for a righteous man will one die; yet perhaps for a good man someone would even dare to die. 8 But God demonstrates His own love toward us, in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us."***
- Agape love is the love God displayed to His enemies... Romans 5:10 (NKJV) ***"For if when we were enemies we were reconciled to God through the death of His Son, much more, having been reconciled,***

we shall be saved by His life.”

If we are going to make an attempt to be like our Heavenly Father by allowing the Fruit of the Spirit to be revealed through us:

- We must love others expecting nothing in return...
- We must be willing to give of ourselves without considering the cost or potential return...
- We must demonstrate love to people who do not deserve it...
- We must actively love our enemies...

Faced with this Scriptural mandate, all of us would probably ask the same question; is it possible for a person to exhibit this kind of love? The answer can only be determined by whether or not we are walking in the Spirit and allowing the Spirit to call the shots within us.

The ability to love in this fashion can only be achieved by accepting and dispensing the love of God as a gift. This kind of love can be experienced only if a person knows God personally. It is not possible to receive or dispense this kind of love without first receiving the person of Christ Jesus into our hearts. Someone said, *“To be with the Saints above is glory; to be with the Saints below, well now that is another story.”*

Romans 5:5 (KJV) *“And hope maketh not ashamed; because the love of God is shed abroad in our hearts by the Holy Ghost which is given unto us.”* The term shed abroad means:

- Spread around...
- Poured out...
- Flooded...

The Christian is mandated to spread around, pour out, and flood the world with the love of God!

According to Jesus, love is the greatest thing in life. Mark 12:30-31 (NKJV) *“You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart, with all your soul, with all your mind, and with all your strength.” This is the first commandment. 31 And the second, like it, is this: ‘You shall love your neighbor as yourself.’ There is no other commandment greater than these.”*

Love is the greatest possession and gift afforded to mere mortals in this

realm. Look at what the Bible has to say about love. [1 Corinthians 13:1-13](#) (The Message) *“If I speak with human eloquence and angelic ecstasy but don't love, I'm nothing but the creaking of a rusty gate. 2 If I speak God's Word with power, revealing all his mysteries and making everything plain as day, and if I have faith that says to a mountain, "Jump," and it jumps, but I don't love, I'm nothing. 3 If I give everything I own to the poor and even go to the stake to be burned as a martyr, but I don't love, I've gotten nowhere. So, no matter what I say, what I believe, and what I do, I'm bankrupt without love. 4 Love never gives up. Love cares more for others than for self. Love doesn't want what it doesn't have. Love doesn't strut, Doesn't have a swelled head, 5 Doesn't force itself on others, Isn't always "me first," Doesn't fly off the handle, Doesn't keep score of the sins of others, 6 Doesn't revel when others grovel, Takes pleasure in the flowering of truth, 7 Puts up with anything, Trusts God always, Always looks for the best, Never looks back, But keeps going to the end. 8 Love never dies. Inspired speech will be over some day; praying in tongues will end; understanding will reach its limit. 9 We know only a portion of the truth, and what we say about God is always incomplete. 10 But when the Complete arrives, our incompletes will be canceled. 11 When I was an infant at my mother's breast, I gurgled and cooed like any infant. When I grew up, I left those infant ways for good. 12 We don't yet see things clearly. We're squinting in a fog, peering through a mist. But it won't be long before the weather clears and the sun shines bright! We'll see it all then, see it all as clearly as God sees us, knowing him directly just as he knows us! 13 But for right now, until that completeness, we have three things to do to lead us toward that consummation: Trust steadily in God, hope unswervingly, love extravagantly. And the best of the three is love.”*

Agape love manifests itself in the following ways:

- Never gives up...
- Cares more for others than for self...
- Does not allow oneself to envy...
- Does not strut...
- Does not allow pride to rule...
- Does not force itself on others...
- Prefers others ahead of self...
- Does not fly off the handle...
- Does not keep a score-sheet of wrongs committed...
- Does not rejoice in the failures of others...

- Takes pleasure in the truth...
- Puts up with anything...
- Trusts God...
- Expects the best...
- Never looks back...
- Perseveres to the end...
- Will never end...

Using this Scripture as a measuring line, how are we doing in the love department?

CONCLUSION:

Paul sets a priority on love for the Corinthian Christians by saying ***“But for right now, until that completeness, we have three things to do to lead us toward that consummation: Trust steadily in God, hope unswervingly, love extravagantly. And the best of the three is love.”***

(END OF WORKSHEET #2)

II. THE COMPONENT OF JOY...

The topic being discussed here is the joy of the Lord. The word joy comes from the Greek word Chara (car-a) which means:

- Inner gladness...
- Deep seated pleasure...

Joy as it is used here is a depth of assurance and confidence that ignites a cheerful, rejoicing heart. The component of joy is a cheerful heart that leads to cheerful, rejoicing behavior!

It must be pointed out; there is a vast difference between the joy of the Lord and the joy of the world. The joy of the world is always followed by:

- A nagging sense of incompleteness...
- A feeling that something is lacking...
- A feeling that there is missing ingredients...
- A feeling that something has been left unfulfilled...
- A feeling that a piece of the puzzle has been misplaced...

The joy which the world offers lack's the ability to deliver a feeling of completion. Somehow there is not a complete sense of assurance, confidence or satisfaction. The most complete sense of joy the world can

offer leaves in its wake a God shaped hole in the soul!

The joy the world offers leaves behind it, a constant awareness which is haunted by an awareness that something can, and probably will go wrong. With this world's joy we are constantly aware that circumstances can change or some situation can arise and disturb our joy. The joy of the world is temporary, at its best. The things which affect the joy of the world are exhaustive, but some of the most common interruptions to the peace which the world offers are:

- Sickness...
- The death of a loved one...
- A sudden financial reversal...
- The loss of secure employment...
- The onslaught of family problems...

If a person is living on the strength of the joy this world offers, when these things develop, their joy is short lived. Living by this worlds system can cause a persons life to emulate a roller-coaster, experiencing highs one day and self-defeating lows the next. A person living on this emotional plane can jump the moon with a single bound today, and tomorrow they can stand up-right and walk under a snake's belly.

Who would want to live on such an emotional see-saw? Even if this joy were consistent it is incomplete. It can never fulfill the individual; as a result, the world is in constant need of things and accomplishments to keep their joyous life going.

I would like to now focus on the joy available to the believer. Some very important facts about the joy of the lord are:

- This joy is divine...
- This joy is given by God...
- This joy can only be acquired by true believers...
- This joy does not depend on circumstances as its source...

The joy of the Lord has nothing to do with earthly or material things; it never rides on cheap triumphs; its source is deep seated peace which flows out of a life lived according to the path which the Spirit has chosen.

Romans 14:17 (NKJV) "For the kingdom of God is not eating and drinking, but righteousness and peace and joy in the Holy Spirit." 1

[Thessalonians 1:6](#) (NKJV) *“And you became followers of us and of the Lord, having received the word in much affliction, with joy of the Holy Spirit.”*

In Acts 13, Paul and Barnabas are preaching at Antioch and they make the bold assertion that the Jew’s rejected the Gospel, and therefore the Gentiles would have opportunity to receive it! Notice what the Scripture say’s happened as a result of this very enlightening information. [Acts 13:50-52](#) (NKJV) *“But the Jews stirred up the devout and prominent women and the chief men of the city, raised up persecution against Paul and Barnabas, and expelled them from their region. 51 But they shook off the dust from their feet against them, and came to Iconium. 52 And the disciples were filled with joy and with the Holy Spirit.”*

I suppose some believers would question whether or not it is God’s will for every true believer to possess this component of joy. I believe [the Scripture teaches that all believers could and should possess this joy.](#) [John 15:11](#) (NKJV) *“These things I have spoken to you, that My joy may remain in you, and that your joy may be full.”*

The joy of the Lord is not dependent on the circumstances of the life of the believer; it is a joy which transcends circumstances and can endure in good times as well as difficult times.

Happiness often times depends upon certain events coming to pass in ones life, but [the joy which God imparts to the believer overrides all things, even matters of life and death.](#) [Psalms 5:11-12](#) (NKJV) *“But let all those rejoice who put their trust in You; Let them ever shout for joy, because You defend them; Let those also who love Your name Be joyful in You. 12 For You, O Lord, will bless the righteous; With favor You will surround him as with a shield.”* [2 Corinthians 7:4](#) (NKJV) *“Great is my boldness of speech toward you, great is my boasting on your behalf. I am filled with comfort. I am exceedingly joyful in all our tribulation.”*

[The reason the joy which God imparts is able to rise above the circumstances is because it has as its seed, faith.](#) [Romans 15:13](#) (NKJV) *“Great is my boldness of speech toward you, great is my boasting on your behalf. I am filled with comfort. I am exceedingly joyful in all our tribulation.”* [Philippians 1:25](#) (NKJV) *“And being confident of this, I*

know that I shall remain and continue with you all for your progress and joy of faith.”

The future reward of a joyful life keeps one faithful. Acts 20:24 (NKJV)
“*But none of these things move me; nor do I count my life dear to myself, so that I may finish my race with joy, and the ministry which I received from the Lord Jesus, to testify to the gospel of the grace of God.*” Hebrews 12:1-2 (NKJV) “*Therefore we also, since we are surrounded by so great a cloud of witnesses, let us lay aside every weight, and the sin which so easily ensnares us, and let us run with endurance the race that is set before us, 2 looking unto Jesus, the author and finisher of our faith, who for the joy that was set before Him endured the cross, despising the shame, and has sat down at the right hand of the throne of God.*”

CONCLUSION:

Every spirit filled believer should be bearing the component of the fruit of joy in our life and walk. If we will allow the Holy Spirit He can cause us to walk in joy, even in times when things may be less than favorable. This walk of joy should be a tremendous witness to all who do not have it.

(END OF WORKSHEET #3)

III. THE COMPONENT OF PEACE...

The word “**Peace**” as it is used here comes from the Greek word “Eirene,” (i-ray-nay) meaning one, quietness, rest, prosperity. Quite literally it means to bind together, to join, to weave together. It means a person is bound, joined, and woven together with God, himself, and others.

The Hebrew word for peace is shalom and means:

- Freedom from trouble...
- Experiencing the highest possible good...
- Possessing the very best possible inner good...
- Wholeness and soundness...
- Prosperity in the widest sense... (Especially prosperity in the spiritual sense of having a soul that blossoms and flourishes!) 3 John 1:2 (NKJV) “*Beloved, I pray that you may prosper in all things and be in health, just as your soul prospers.*”

When one speaks of peace the discussion could encompass any number of subjects but I want us to focus on peace in three forums:

1) The peace of the world...

This is a peace which is born of:

- Escapism...
- Avoiding conflict...
- Refusing to face issues...

The peace the world offers is predicated on a lack of reality and as a result, it cannot endure. This peace is sought through:

- Pleasure...
- Contentment...
- The absence of trouble...
- The power of positive thinking...

2) The peace of God... The peace of God is a deep seated peace which finds a home deep within the human soul. The peace of God is a tranquility of mind; composure; and restfulness that is undisturbed by situations and circumstances. The peace of God is more than feelings; it is even more than attitude or a frame of mind; the peace of God is an indicator of the conquest of God over the human soul. **John 16:33 (NKJV) “*These things I have spoken to you, that in Me you may have peace. In the world you will have tribulation; but be of good cheer, I have overcome the world.*”**

This peace is independent of conditions and environment! This peace does not evaporate with the onslaught of sorrow, suffering, danger, or a negative life experience!

This peace is brought about by:

- Intimacy with God... **Philippians 4:6-7 (NKJV) “*Be anxious for nothing, but in everything by prayer and supplication, with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God; and the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding, will guard your hearts and minds through Christ Jesus.*”**
- Inner assurance which is born of God...
- Unquestionable confidence in the ability of God...
- A sure knowledge that one’s life is in the hands of God... **Romans 8:28 (NKJV) “*And we know that all things work together for good to***

those who love God, to those who are the called according to His purpose.”

This peace:

- Settles the mind...
- Strengthens the will...
- Establishes the heart...

The source of true peace is always born out of reconciliation between God and man. The ability of man to be reconciled to God can only be brought about by the cross of Christ! [Colossians 1:20-22](#) (NKJV) ***“And by Him to reconcile all things to Himself, by Him, whether things on earth or things in heaven, having made peace through the blood of His cross.**²¹ And you, who once were alienated and enemies in your mind by wicked works, yet now He has reconciled²² in the body of His flesh through death, to present you holy, and blameless, and above reproach in His sight.”*

The peace which Christ gives guarantees freedom from the daily persistence of aggravation brought on by the terrible weight of anguish, guilt, loneliness, emptiness, and fear. Christ brings a still deeper sense of peace when we realize that He has brought perfect love and unity to the world through the elimination of divisions and barriers between God and man.

3) Peace between individuals... His reconciliation also eliminates all differences between men. This is accomplished by bringing men together as one. [Ephesians 2:13-14](#) (NKJV) ***“But now in Christ Jesus you who once were far off have been brought near by the blood of Christ.**¹⁴ For He Himself is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of separation.”* Note that He has made *“both one,”* that is, Jew and Gentile. This was not welcome news for the Jewish audience but Christ’s reason for coming to this world also included providing a common denominator to bring men together under one tent of purpose.

Through Christ:

- All men now approach God on the same basis... The ground at the foot of the cross is level! Everyone makes his approach to God on an equal footing, which is through the blood of Christ. There is no other way! Therefore, when a man comes to the cross, he comes with everyone else who is standing at the feet of Jesus. When standing on the ground at the foot of the Cross, the Sinner is not accepted by God

because he is better; healthier; wealthier; more intelligent; more capable; or more religious than anyone else. He is acceptable to God because He acknowledges his desperate need of forgiveness through the blood of Christ. He is acceptable to God because he acknowledges that he is as all other men, lost and astray and he comes as one with all other men to confess Christ as his Savior. [Romans 5:1](#) (NKJV) ***“Therefore, having been justified by faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ.”*** [Colossians 1:20](#) (NKJV) ***“And by Him to reconcile all things to Himself, by Him, whether things on earth or things in heaven, having made peace through the blood of His cross.”***

- All men who come to Christ for salvation receive a [common love, purpose, and moral code](#)... The DNA of every believer should be that we love God and each other; we are absolutely committed to His purpose in the earth; and by an act of our own will, we devote ourselves to His code of ethics.

The outgrowth of this life is peace:

- Peace with [God](#)...
- Peace [within](#)...
- Peace with [others](#)...

Peace with God stirs love for all those whom Christ loves.

The peace of God breaks down all barriers. [Ephesians 2:14](#) (NKJV) ***“For He Himself is our peace, who has made both one, and has broken down the middle wall of separation.”*** In this Scripture Paul decides to paint a word picture for his audience which he knew they would understand. He makes reference to a very familiar part of Temple worship. The temple was surrounded by a series of courts. Each court had a high wall separating it from the preceding court. [As one approached the temple, he entered:](#)

- The [outer Court of the Gentiles](#)... This is where the buying and selling of animals and the exchanging of money for foreign worshippers took place.
- The Court of the [women](#)... A Jewish woman was limited to this court unless she had come to offer a sacrifice...
- The Court of the [Israelites](#)... This is where the whole congregation gathered on the great feast days and where sacrifices were handed over to the priests.

- [The Court of the Priests...](#) This court was in the temple proper where the temple itself stood. This area was considered sacred and was accessible only to the services of the priests.
- [The Holy of Holies...](#) This court was also known as the Most Holy Place! This is where the very presence of God was to dwell. Only the High Priest could enter the Holy of Holies, and he could enter only once a year, during the time of the Feast of Passover.

Imagine this, partition after partition separated people from the presence of God. Tablets hung around the wall of the Gentile Court announcing that if a Gentile or an otherwise unauthorized person walked into any other court, he was to be put to death.

The picture being presented here is that of Jesus Christ breaking down all barriers and walls which separated man from God and also the walls which separated men from one another.

Because of the work of Christ all men can now approach God equally through the death of Jesus Christ. The walls being demolished ushers in a much needed peace.

Men build all kinds of barriers and prejudices against other men. [Society is plagued with barriers and prejudices built around such things as:](#)

- [Race...](#)
- [Religion...](#)
- [Education...](#)
- [Social standing...](#)

Though men attempt to compartmentalize the world, the work of Christ is to demolish all barriers and prejudices which tend to divide us. The Apostle Peter speaking in the house of Cornelius gives us a snapshot into the difficulties which arise from prejudices. [Acts 10:28](#) (NKJV) ***“Then he said to them, “You know how unlawful it is for a Jewish man to keep company with or go to one of another nation. But God has shown me that I should not call any man common or unclean.”***

Jesus came to break down all barriers by the blood of His cross. [Romans 10:12](#) (NKJV) ***“For there is no distinction between Jew and Greek, for the same Lord over all is rich to all who call upon Him.”*** [Galatians 3:28](#)

(NKJV) ***“There is neither Jew nor Greek, there is neither slave nor free, there is neither male nor female; for you are all one in Christ Jesus.”***

As a result, all men now approach God and become worthy of His fellowship on the same basis; by bowing before the cross and surrendering their lives to God’s Son, the Lord Jesus Christ. **Matthew 23:8** (NKJV) ***“But you, do not be called ‘Rabbi’; for One is your Teacher, the Christ, and you are all brethren.”***

Before Christ, man had to approach God through law but the law did not make him acceptable to God; it condemned him and showed him how far away from God he really was; the realization was that man was totally depraved. Under such an economy, every time a person broke the law, the law cried out “*guilty*” and pronounced the penalty of being unworthy, imperfect, and unacceptable to God. (Think of the instances in the Old Testament in which justice was delivered without being tempered with grace... People were struck dead – ground opened – snakes – diseases....etc)

Christ satisfied the law through His sinless life, as such, He became the **embodiment of the law**. Because of this He is the only path for a man to approach God. We must come to Him on the terms of grace rather than law. Therefore, there are no laws, no rules, and no decrees to keep men from God. Only one thing can keep a man from God and that is a refusal to come to God through His Son Jesus Christ. **Matthew 5:17** (NKJV) ***“Do not think that I came to destroy the Law or the Prophets. I did not come to destroy but to fulfill.”*** **Romans 8:3** (NKJV) ***“For what the law could not do in that it was weak through the flesh, God did by sending His own Son in the likeness of sinful flesh, on account of sin: He condemned sin in the flesh.”*** **Galatians 3:13** (NKJV) ***“Christ has redeemed us from the curse of the law, having become a curse for us for it is written, “Cursed is everyone who hangs on a tree”*** **Galatians 4:4-5** (NKJV) ***“But when the fullness of the time had come, God sent forth His Son, born of a woman, born under the law,5 to redeem those who were under the law, that we might receive the adoption as sons.”***

The peace which Christ promises to deliver is created through the formation of a new man. Individually when a man turns to Christ, Christ causes the man to be born again, and this new beginning creates a climate of peace which translates into peace of heart and peace of mind.

Corporately, in Jesus Christ all men who believe, both Jew and Gentile, make up:

- One new body...
- One new family...
- One new building...
- One new fellowship...

Because of the common denominator of Jesus, all these entities are entitled to the peace which the Prince of Peace promises.

The bottom line is that if we have peace through the Lord Jesus Christ, then we will be at peace with God, ourselves, and others.

(END OF WORKSHEET #4)

IV. THE COMPONENT OF LONG-SUFFERING...

This particular component of the fruit of the Spirit seems to be out of place in the middle of all the other character traits being focused on here. The aspect of suffering seems to me misplaced amidst love, joy, peace, goodness, and so on. A closer look will show that it is not out of place at all. Long-suffering comes from the Greek word Makrothumia and means patience; bearing and suffering a long time; perseverance; being constant; steadfast; and enduring. In other words, long-suffering never gives in; it is never frustrated enough to retaliate no matter what attacks it.

Webster defines long-suffering in this way: Bearing injuries, insults, and troubles patiently for a long time. To be long-suffering means long and patient endurance of trials. How does the component of being long-suffering look in our lives?

- Trials, stress, pressure and adversity will no doubt come upon all of us, but the Spirit of God helps us to do what does not come naturally, be long-suffering.
- Disease, accidents, or old age may afflict us but the Spirit of God helps us to be long-suffering through it all.
- Men may do us wrong, abuse, slander, and injure us; but the Spirit of God helps us to be long-suffering.

Two significant things need to be noted about a long-suffering attitude:

- To maintain a spirit which is long-suffering means the person who operates in this attitude never strikes back. Common sense tells us that a person who is attacked by others should strike back and

- retaliate. But the Christian believer is given the power of a long-suffering spirit. This is the power to suffer the situation or person for a long, long time without giving in to the need to get even.
- The ability to walk free of the need to strike back or get even is not natural, it is divine. This character trait can only be carried out by a person who is walking in the Spirit. The ability to be long-suffering is a fruit or outgrowth of the spirit filled life.

The reason the component of long-suffering is mentioned in this list of components of the fruit of the Spirit is because each of these items are a character trait of God and long-suffering is one of them. The Scripture declares that God is long-suffering toward sinners. **Romans 2:4** (NKJV) ***“Or do you despise the riches of His goodness, forbearance, and longsuffering, not knowing that the goodness of God leads you to repentance?”*** Since God suffers long with those who reject Him, once a person becomes a believer they are to emulate the character of God by means of becoming a long-suffering person. **1 Timothy 1:16** (NKJV) ***“For this reason I obtained mercy, that in me first Jesus Christ might show all longsuffering, as a pattern to those who are going to believe on Him for everlasting life.”***

Have you ever wondered how the world can be so wicked yet it seems that God is not given to Judgment? **God withholds His judgment from the world because He is long-suffering, waiting for more and more people to be saved.** **2 Peter 3:15** (NKJV) ***“Consider that the longsuffering of our Lord is salvation...”*** **Isaiah 48:9** (NKJV) ***“For My name’s sake I will defer My anger, And for My praise I will restrain it from you, So that I do not cut you off.”*** We used to sing a song in church which illustrates this point: *“Wait a little longer, please Jesus; just a few more days to get our loved ones in.”*

Barclay says, *“If God had been a man, He would have long ago wiped man off the face of the earth because of his terrible disobedience.”*

Man is Gods crowning creation, as a result God loves and cares for man; therefore, God is long-suffering toward him. In other words, God is suffering a long, long time with man because he is allowing more and more time for men to be saved.

Once we are saved we are to begin to emulate the characteristics of our Heavenly Father and one way to do this is to become long-suffering.

Colossians 1:10-12 (NKJV) ***"That you may walk worthy of the Lord, fully pleasing Him, being fruitful in every good work and increasing in the knowledge of God;11 strengthened with all might, according to His glorious power, for all patience and longsuffering with joy;12 giving thanks to the Father who has qualified us to be partakers of the inheritance of the saints in the light."*** 2 Timothy 4:2 (NKJV) ***"Preach the word! Be ready in season and out of season. Convince, rebuke, exhort, with all longsuffering and teaching."***

CONCLUSION: If God was long-suffering toward us when we were sinners, and He was, then He will require us to be long-suffering with others! Matthew 18:23-35 (NLT) ***"For this reason, the Kingdom of Heaven can be compared to a king who decided to bring his accounts up to date with servants who had borrowed money from him. 24 In the process, one of his debtors was brought in who owed him millions of dollars. 25 He couldn't pay, so the king ordered that he, his wife, his children, and everything he had be sold to pay the debt. 26 But the man fell down before the king and begged him, 'Oh, sir, be patient with me, and I will pay it all.' 27 Then the king was filled with pity for him, and he released him and forgave his debt. 28 "But when the man left the king, he went to a fellow servant who owed him a few thousand dollars. He grabbed him by the throat and demanded instant payment. 29 His fellow servant fell down before him and begged for a little more time. 'Be patient and I will pay it,' he pleaded. 30 But his creditor wouldn't wait. He had the man arrested and jailed until the debt could be paid in full. 31 "When some of the other servants saw this, they were very upset. They went to the king and told him what had happened. 32 Then the king called in the man he had forgiven and said, 'You evil servant! I forgave you that tremendous debt because you pleaded with me. 33 Shouldn't you have mercy on your fellow servant, just as I had mercy on you?' 34 Then the angry king sent the man to prison until he had paid every penny. 35 "That's what my heavenly Father will do to you if you refuse to forgive your brothers and sisters in your heart."*** Jesus makes it pretty plain here as to what will happen to those who have been forgiven of their sins and then fail to forgive others of their trespasses. It is in our best interest to allow the fruit of the Spirit to operate in our lives by means of extending a long-suffering attitude to everyone else in our lives.

(END OF WORKSHEET #5)

V. THE COMPONENT OF GENTLENESS...

The Scripture declares that gentleness is a component of the fruit of the Spirit. In the Greek, **Gentleness** (Charsetotes) is defined in the following way:

- Kind and good...
- Useful and helpful...
- Gentle and sweet...
- Considerate and gracious...

This should be the case in all situations no matter the circumstances.

Just as the Gifts of the Spirit can be broken down into three categories, the Fruit of the Spirit can be viewed in three categories as well:

- Love, joy, and peace, which defines our relationship to God...
- Long-suffering, gentleness, and goodness, having to do with our relationship to our fellow man...
- Faith, meekness, and temperance, having to do with the conduct of our own individual Christian life...

The first group blends naturally into the second, for there is a close relationship between peace, and long-suffering. The graces of the group begin with the passive and end with the active.

Long-suffering is the patient endurance of injuries inflicted by others. On the other hand, goodness is an active principle, not just merely a naturally kind disposition. Gentleness or kindness finds its place somewhere between the two. Gentleness acts as a shock absorber lessening the friction that enters all human relationships from time to time.

A person walking in the boundaries of a gentle spirit does not act:

- Harsh...
- Bitter...
- Indifferent...
- Unconcerned...
- Too busy to care...

Gentleness cares for the feelings of others and empathizes with them. Gentleness experiences the full depth of sympathy and empathy. It shows care and rolls up its sleeves getting right into the situation alongside a

person.

Gentleness:

- Works with those who work...
- Suffers with those who suffer...
- Struggles with those who struggle...
- Rejoices with those who rejoice...

The nature of God is to be gentle and kind. When God's Word instructs us to take on a character trait it is because our Father exemplifies that trait as well. Luke 6:35 (NKJV) ***"But love your enemies, do good, and lend, hoping for nothing in return; and your reward will be great, and you will be sons of the Most High. For He is kind to the unthankful and evil."***

Look at the kind of care believers are commanded to have for one another:

- Romans 12:10 (NKJV) ***"Be kindly affectionate to one another with brotherly love, in honor giving preference to one another."***
- Ephesians 4:32 (NKJV) ***"And be kind to one another, tenderhearted, forgiving one another, just as God in Christ forgave you."***
- Colossians 3:12-15 (NKJV) ***"Therefore, as the elect of God, holy and beloved, put on tender mercies, kindness, humility, meekness, longsuffering;13 bearing with one another, and forgiving one another, if anyone has a complaint against another; even as Christ forgave you, so you also must do.14 But above all these things put on love, which is the bond of perfection.15 And let the peace of God rule in your hearts, to which also you were called in one body; and be thankful."***
- 2 Peter 1:4-8 (NKJV) ***"You have been given to us exceedingly great and precious promises, that through these you may be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through lust. 5 But also for this very reason, giving all diligence, add to your faith virtue, to virtue knowledge,6 to knowledge self-control, to self-control perseverance, to perseverance godliness,7 to godliness brotherly kindness, and to brotherly kindness love.8 For if these things are yours and abound, you will be neither barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ."*** The Greek word for brother (Adelphos) means "from the same womb!" People who have brotherly love have come from the same womb, that is,

from the same source. They have been born again by the Spirit of God through faith in the Lord Jesus Christ. When we receive this new birth, we receive a new spirit from God. This new spirit binds our hearts together with cords of love and gentleness which cannot, and will not be broken!

Gentleness is the Divine ability to deal with others gently rather than harshly and this method of conducting relationships is the order of our Heavenly Father. Proverbs 15:1 (NKJV) *“A soft answer turns away wrath, But a harsh word stirs up anger.”* 1 Peter 3:8 (NKJV) *“Finally, all of you be of one mind, having compassion for one another; love as brothers, be tenderhearted, be courteous. 9 not returning evil for evil or reviling for reviling, but on the contrary blessing, knowing that you were called to this, that you may inherit a blessing.”*

The strength of this new found spirit of gentleness will often be tested but should never be destroyed. The question becomes, *“Are we willing to allow the Heavenly Father to develop a spirit of gentleness within us?”*

(END OF WORKSHEET #6)

VI. THE COMPONENT OF GOODNESS...

The component of goodness (agathosune) means to be full of virtue, excellence, kindness, helpfulness, peace and consideration. It means that a person is full of everything good and manifests that goodness through the actions, habits, and everyday routines of his life. The person who operates in goodness becomes a quality individual on every level.

With this component of the Fruit of the Spirit, we are not speaking of that which issues out of the human nature of mankind we are speaking of the goodness of God flowing through the believer.

There are people whose natural born personality is one of a nature of goodness, they are kind-hearted and easy-going. Others of us were not fortunate enough to receive such a nature. As a believer, we do not need to depend upon natural born instincts, because we have been reborn, or born again by the Spirit of God, and now we are walking according to the nature of our Heavenly Father. Psalm 34:8 (NKJV) *“Oh, taste and see that the LORD is good; Blessed is the man who trusts in Him!”* Psalm 33:5 (NKJV) *“He loves righteousness and justice; The earth is full of the goodness of the LORD.”* Romans 15:14 (NKJV) *“Now I myself am confident*

concerning you, my brethren, that you also are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish one another.”

Note that a person, who has the component of the fruit of goodness operating in their life, lives and treats everyone just as they should be treated. [Ephesians 5:9](#) (NKJV) “*For the fruit of the Spirit is in all goodness, righteousness, and truth.*” This person does not take advantage of any other person, nor does he stand by and let others take advantage of them. Such a person stands up for that which is right and good and just. Goodness involves discipline, rebuke, correction and instruction as well as love, care, peace and conciliation. [Paul was a man filled with goodness, yet he says the following to his young son-in-the-faith. 2 Timothy 4:1-2](#) (NKJV) “*I charge you therefore before God and the Lord Jesus Christ, who will judge the living and the dead at His appearing and His kingdom:2 Preach the word! Be ready in season and out of season. Convince, rebuke, exhort, with all longsuffering and teaching.*” A person operating in the fruit of goodness:

- Will not give license to evil deeds...
- Will not allow evil to run rampant in his life...
- Will not allow evil to indulge itself and treat others unjustly...
- Will not allow others to suffer evil...

Goodness steps forward and does what it can to stop, and destroy evil actions. [2 Thessalonians 1:11](#) (NKJV) “*Therefore we also pray always for you that our God would count you worthy of this calling, and fulfill all the good pleasure of His goodness and the work of faith with power.*”

Believers are commanded to be full of the goodness of God. [Romans 15:14](#) (NKJV) “*Now I myself am confident concerning you, my brethren, that you also are full of goodness, filled with all knowledge, able also to admonish one another.*” [Ephesians 3:19](#) (NKJV) “*To know the love of Christ which passes knowledge; that you may be filled with all the fullness of God.*”

(END OF WORKSHEET #7)

VII. THE COMPONENT OF FAITH...

Every single human being has faith:

- We are born with faith... Romans 12:3 (NKJV) *“For I say, through the grace given to me, to everyone who is among you, not to think of himself more highly than he ought to think, but to think soberly, as God has dealt to each one a measure of faith.”*
- We receive Christ through faith... Galatians 3:6-8 (KJV) *“Even as Abraham believed God, and it was accounted to him for righteousness. ⁷Know ye therefore that they which are of faith, the same are the children of Abraham. ⁸And the scripture, foreseeing that God would justify the heathen through faith...”* Ephesians 2:8 (KJV) *“For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God.”*
- We receive the Spirit through faith... Galatians 3:13-14 (KJV) *“Christ hath redeemed us from the curse of the law, being made a curse for us: for it is written, Cursed is every one that hangeth on a tree: ¹⁴That the blessing of Abraham might come on the Gentiles through Jesus Christ; that we might receive the promise of the Spirit through faith.”*
- We can receive faith as a gift... 1 Corinthians 12:8-10 (NKJV) *“For to one is given the word of wisdom through the Spirit, to another the word of knowledge through the same Spirit,⁹ to another faith by the same Spirit...”*
- We should model it as a fruit of the Spirit...

In the context of faith as a fruit of the Spirit the word faith (πιστις) means to be faithful and trustworthy; to be loyal and steadfast in devotion and allegiance. It means to be constant, staunch, and enduring.

A faithful person stands ready to deny and sacrifice all he is to bring glory and honor to God. A faithful person will prefer others ahead of self. The reason a faithful person can do these things is because they have placed their trust in God rather than self or men and is being controlled by the Spirit. A faithful person believes God and knows that God will work all things out for good. Romans 8:28 (NKJV) *“And we know that all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are the called according to His purpose.”* Because the faithful person knows and believes this truth he is able to cast himself totally upon God and become faithful to God in all situations and circumstances.

Faithfulness:

- Refuses to doubt God...

- Refuses to doubt His [salvation](#)...
- Refuses to doubt His [provision](#)...
- Refuses to doubt His [strength](#)...
- Refuses to doubt His [help](#)...

Faithfulness does not begin with God, then back off and give up; faithfulness does not walk with God then give in to the lusts of the flesh; faithfulness begins with God, continues with God, and ends with God! Faithfulness continues on and on; it never slacks up or surrenders!

God demand faithfulness of His followers but He [delivers](#) on faithfulness as well. 1 Corinthians 10:13 (NKJV) *“No temptation has overtaken you except such as is common to man; but God is faithful, who will not allow you to be tempted beyond what you are able, but with the temptation will also make the way of escape, that you may be able to bear it.”* 1 Corinthians 1:9 (NKJV) *“God is faithful, by whom you were called into the fellowship of His Son, Jesus Christ our Lord.”* 1 Peter 4:19 (NKJV) *“Therefore let those who suffer according to the will of God commit their souls to Him in doing good, as to a faithful Creator.”*

Because the very nature of God is faithfulness, He keeps all His covenants. Deuteronomy 7:9 (NKJV) *“Therefore know that the LORD your God, He is God, the faithful God who keeps covenant and mercy for a thousand generations with those who love Him and keep His commandments...”* Think of this, if He keeps His covenants for “A thousand generations” and a generation is forty years, then His promise is good for a minimum of forty thousand years. What is being said here is that His promises are good forever!

God made many covenants with man and never defaulted on one of them. I want us to look at the [seven Covenants God made with man and His faithfulness to each of them](#):

- The [everlasting covenant](#)... Of course this Covenant has to do with the plan of salvation for man. Titus 1:1-2 (NKJV) *“Paul, a bondservant of God and an apostle of Jesus Christ, according to the faith of God’s elect and the acknowledgment of the truth which accords with godliness, in hope of eternal life which God, who cannot lie, promised before time began,”*

- **Gods covenant with [Adam](#)...** This Covenant of course has to do with the covenant God made with Adam and more specifically has to do with obedience and disobedience... **Genesis 2:16-17 (NKJV)** ***“And the LORD God commanded the man, saying, “Of every tree of the garden you may freely eat; But of the tree of the knowledge of good and evil you shall not eat, for in the day that you eat of it you shall surely die.”***
- **Gods covenant with [Noah](#)...** This covenant has to do with grace. **Genesis 9:8-15 (NKJV)** ***“Then God spoke to Noah and to his sons with him, saying:9 “And as for Me, behold, I establish My covenant with you and with your descendants after you,10 “and with every living creature that is with you: the birds, the cattle, and every beast of the earth with you, of all that go out of the ark, every beast of the earth.11 “Thus I establish My covenant with you: Never again shall all flesh be cut off by the waters of the flood; never again shall there be a flood to destroy the earth.”12 And God said: “This is the sign of the covenant which I make between Me and you, and every living creature that is with you, for perpetual generations:13 “I set My rainbow in the cloud, and it shall be for the sign of the covenant between Me and the earth.14 “It shall be, when I bring a cloud over the earth, that the rainbow shall be seen in the cloud;15 “and I will remember My covenant which is between Me and you and every living creature of all flesh; the waters shall never again become a flood to destroy all flesh.”*** A period of sixteen centuries had come and gone between the time God made a covenant with Adam, which had to do with works, and the time he made a covenant with Noah, which was grace through-and-through. The grace of God knows no limits; the songwriter defined it in this way “*amazing grace.*”
- **Gods covenant with [Abraham](#)...** This covenant has to do with blessing and more specifically the ancestry of Christ. **Genesis 12:1-3 (NKJV)** ***“Now the LORD had said to Abram: “Get out of your country, From your family And from your father’s house, To a land that I will show you. 2 I will make you a great nation; I will bless you And make your name great; And you shall be a blessing. 3 I will bless those who bless you, And I will curse him who curses you; And in you all the families of the earth shall be blessed.”*** This covenant was made 300 years after Noah’s covenant.

- [The covenant at Sinai...](#) This Covenant had to do with law. (The Ten Commandments. [Exodus 20:1-17](#)) The law was given to bring men to the knowledge of sin. It was designed to mark the boundaries between acceptable and unacceptable behavior.
- [Gods covenant with David...](#) [2 Samuel 7:12-16](#) (NKJV) ***"When your days are fulfilled and you rest with your fathers, I will set up your seed after you, who will come from your body, and I will establish his kingdom.13 "He shall build a house for My name, and I will establish the throne of his kingdom forever.14 "I will be his Father, and he shall be My son. If he commits iniquity, I will chasten him with the rod of men and with the blows of the sons of men.15 "But My mercy shall not depart from him, as I took it from Saul, whom I removed from before you.16 "And your house and your kingdom shall be established forever before you. Your throne shall be established forever."*** This covenant has to do with the establishing of the throne of David, and also the drawing of the parallels between Christ's kingdom and that of David. This Covenant has to do with the eternal leadership of the Saints in the kingdom of Christ.
- [The Messianic covenant...](#) This covenant is spelled out from one end of the Bible to the other, and has to do with everything! From the time Adam and Eve sinned God began speaking promises of a coming Messiah. [Genesis 3:14-15](#) (NKJV) ***"So the LORD God said to the serpent: "Because you have done this, You are cursed more than all cattle, And more than every beast of the field; On your belly you shall go, And you shall eat dust All the days of your life. 15 And I will put enmity Between you and the woman, And between your seed and her Seed; He shall bruise your head, And you shall bruise His heel."*** It is a fact that Old Testament prophecy concerning the first coming and the ministry of the Messiah were fulfilled to the letter in the New Testament. He was the ***"seed of a woman"*** - Prophecy: Genesis 3:15 - Fulfilled: Galatians 4:4. He was a ***"descendent of Abraham"*** - Prophecy: Genesis 12:3 – Fulfilled: Matthew 1:1. He was from ***"the tribe of Judah"*** – Prophecy: Genesis 49:10 - Fulfilled: Luke 3:33. He was the ***"heir to the throne of David"*** – Prophecy: Isaiah 9:7 – Fulfilled: Luke 1:32-33. His birth place was ***"in Bethlehem"*** – Prophecy: Micah 5:2 - Fulfilled: John 1:2, Luke 2:4-5, 7. He was ***"born of a virgin"*** – Prophecy: Isaiah 7:14 - Fulfilled: Luke 1:26-27, 30-31. There are many others that we could cite,

including the time of His birth, rejection by His own, a priest after the order of Melchizedek, betrayed by a friend for thirty pieces of silver, accused by false witnesses, crucified with malefactors, pierced through hands and feet, soldiers gambled for his clothing, no bones broken, His side pierced, buried with the rich, and raised from the dead. There are 44 Old Testament prophecies that were fulfilled at the Messiah's first coming. The fact that all of the Old Testament prophecy concerning the Messiah and His first coming has come true with such detail brings clarity to the issue of what is going to happen in the future. There are prophecies concerning the Messiah that still await fulfillment. The biggest lesson for us to learn here is that God keeps His promises and just as the prophecies concerning the coming Messiah have been fulfilled in Christ Jesus' first coming, so the rest of the messianic prophecies will be fulfilled in the second coming.

Have you noticed that [the only way any of these covenants could be set aside is for the people in question to refuse to abide by the guidelines of the Covenant?](#)

Our [God is without question a covenant keeping God.](#) 1 Kings 8:56 (NKJV) ***“Blessed be the LORD, who has given rest to His people Israel, according to all that He promised. There has not failed one word of all His good promise, which He promised through His servant Moses.”*** Psalm 89:1 (NKJV) ***“A Contemplation of Ethan the Ezrahite. I will sing of the mercies of the LORD forever; With my mouth will I make known Your faithfulness to all generations.”***

Just as our God is faithful He calls upon His [followers](#) to be faithful as well. 1 Corinthians 4:2 (NKJV) ***“Moreover it is required in stewards that one be found faithful.”*** Just as any other component of the fruit of the Spirit issues out of a Spirit filled life, so faithfulness can only be attained as a result of a life lived in the Spirit.

(END OF WORKSHEET #8)

VIII. THE COMPONENT OF MEEKNESS...

This component of the fruit of the Spirit is called meekness. [The word meekness](#) (prautes) [means to be gentle, tender, humble, mild, considerate, but strongly so.](#) One misconception of meekness is that it is oftentimes associated with weakness. Meekness has enough strength to keep the believer under control, living a disciplined life. Meekness is to the believer

what a voltage regulator is to an engine; what a surge protector is to an electronic device or appliance.

Meekness causes the believer to maintain a humble state of mind while not allowing for weakness in his walk or cowardice in his character. Notice the word's of Jesus. Matthew 5:5 (NKJV) ***"Blessed are the meek, For they shall inherit the earth."*** It would be preposterous to think that God would allow a group of weak willed, spineless, vacillating, non-committal folks to inherit the earth He created. The meek person simply loves people and loves peace; therefore, he walks humbly among men regardless of their status or circumstance in life. These are the kind of people who will rule in the Millennial Reign of Christ.

Associating with the poor and lowly of this earth does not bother the meek person; he desires to be a friend to all and to help wherever possible.

Meekness brings with it a strong state of mind. It looks at situations and wants justice and will contend for the right actions to be taken. It rejects anything which ignores evil and wrong-doing, abuse and suffering. If someone is suffering or being treated unjustly meekness steps in and does what it can to help. Galatians 6:1 (KJV) ***"Brethren, if a man be overtaken in a fault, ye which are spiritual, restore such an one in the spirit of meekness; considering thyself, lest thou also be tempted."***

If evil is running rampant and indulging itself, meekness actually strikes out in anger. However, note a crucial point: the anger which meekness displays is always:

- At the right time...
- For the right reason...
- Against the right thing...
- For the right duration of time...

(Example of Jesus running the money changers out of the Temple.)

Meekness allows the believer to exercise strong self-control in difficult situations. When we walk in meekness we allow the Holy Spirit to control

our spirit and mind thus bringing under control the lusts of his flesh.
Because of this we do not give way to:

- Passion...
- Ill-temper...
- Retaliation...
- Indulgence...

2 Timothy 2:25 (KJV) ***“In meekness instructing those that oppose themselves; if God peradventure will give them repentance to the acknowledging of the truth.”***

When we exercise meekness we die to self, not allowing our flesh to do what it would like to do. When we walk in meekness we will always do the right thing which is exactly what God wants us to do.

In summary, when we allow the Spirit to manifest meekness through us we will be humble and tender while maintaining a strong state of mind; denying ourselves, giving utmost consideration to others. When we walk in meekness we are forgiving, and made willing to live our life for others. This can only be accomplished through the Spirit and an awareness of what Jesus has done for us, coupled with a desire to pass the forgiveness which we have so freely received along to others.

Remember:

God has provided the ability to be meek through His own meekness...

Jesus modeled a meek spirit and attitude... Matthew 11:29 (NKJV) ***“Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest unto your souls.*”**

Believers are certainly admonished to allow a meek spirit to operate through them. Ephesians 4:1-3 (KJV) ***“I therefore, the prisoner of the Lord, beseech you that ye walk worthy of the vocation wherewith ye are called, 2 With all lowliness and meekness, with longsuffering, forbearing one another in love; 3 Endeavouring to keep the unity of the Spirit in the bond of peace.”*** James 1:21 (KJV) ***“Wherefore lay apart all filthiness and superfluity of naughtiness, and receive with meekness the engrafted word, which is able to save your souls.”*** James 3:13 (KJV) ***“Who is a wise man and endued with knowledge among you? let him shew out of a good conversation his works with meekness of wisdom.”*** 1 Peter 3:4 (KJV) ***“But***

let it be the hidden man of the heart, in that which is not corruptible, even the ornament of a meek and quiet spirit, which is in the sight of God of great price.”

(END OF WORKSHEET #9)

IX. THE COMPONENT OF TEMPERANCE...

The word temperance (egkrateia) means to master and control the body or the flesh with all its lusts.

Being a meek person means to:

- Be self-controlled...
- Master the giant of desire...
- Control our appetites...
- Properly manage our passions and sensual urges...
- Be strong, controlled and restrained...
- To successfully stand against the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eye, and the pride of life...

The accomplishment of all of these things can only be achieved through the power of the Holy Spirit. 1 John 2:15-16 (NKJV) ***“Do not love the world or the things in the world. If anyone loves the world, the love of the Father is not in him. 16 For all that is in the world—the lust of the flesh, the lust of the eyes, and the pride of life—is not of the Father but is of the world.”***

Temperance is probably more readily recognized in our culture as self-control. Being able to control self must be a God thing rather than a me thing.

The believer is enjoined to live a life of self-control as a witness to the lost world. This is a very distinguishing trait as we live in a world which is reeling out of control. Self-control separates the believer from those who live under the influence of the god of this world because they are being driven along by their passions and desires! Paul discovered this as he dealt with Felix. Acts 24:25 (NKJV) ***“Now as he reasoned about righteousness, self-control, and the judgment to come, Felix was afraid and answered, “Go away for now; when I have a convenient time I will call for you.”***

The fear Felix was grappling with here was conviction for his life of no

restraint. When he could no longer take the conviction he sent Paul away. For Felix it was an “*out-of-sight, out-of-mind*” mentality which is alive and well in our culture. If a person gets under conviction at one church they will just keep changing churches until they find a church which will tolerate their sin. Rather than exercising temperance the individual often chooses the path of least resistance.

The believer is to strenuously exercise a spirit of self control in all areas of his life, just as an athlete controls himself. 1 Corinthians 9:25 (NKJV) “*And everyone who competes for the prize is temperate in all things. Now they do it to obtain a perishable crown, but we for an imperishable crown.*”

The believer should exercise self-control in the following areas:

- Conduct – Ephesians 4:22-27 (NKJV) “*Put off, concerning your former conduct, the old man which grows corrupt according to the deceitful lusts,²³ and be renewed in the spirit of your mind,²⁴ and that you put on the new man which was created according to God, in true righteousness and holiness. ²⁵ Therefore, putting away lying, “Let each one of you speak truth with his neighbor,” for we are members of one another.²⁶ “Be angry, and do not sin”: do not let the sun go down on your wrath,²⁷ nor give place to the devil.”*
- Conversation – Hebrews 13:5-6 (KJV) “*Let your conversation be without covetousness; and be content with such things as ye have: for he hath said, I will never leave thee, nor forsake thee. ⁶ So that we may boldly say, The Lord is my helper, and I will not fear what man shall do unto me.*” Colossians 4:5-6 (NKJV) “*Walk in wisdom toward those who are outside, redeeming the time.⁶ Let your speech always be with grace, seasoned with salt, that you may know how you ought to answer each one.”*
- Sexual desires – Matthew 5:28 (NKJV) “*But I say to you that whoever looks at a woman to lust for her has already committed adultery with her in his heart.”* 1 Thessalonians 4:3 (NKJV) “*This is the will of God, your sanctification: that you should abstain from sexual immorality.”*

The believer is to be continuously growing in self-control and this will occur as we learn to allow the Spirit to control more and more of our life and walk. 2 Peter 1:4-9 (NKJV) “*By which have been given to us exceedingly great and precious promises, that through these you may be partakers of the divine nature, having escaped the corruption that is in the world through*

lust. 5 But also for this very reason, giving all diligence, add to your faith virtue, to virtue knowledge,6 to knowledge self-control, to self-control perseverance, to perseverance godliness,7 to godliness brotherly kindness, and to brotherly kindness love.8 For if these things are yours and abound, you will be neither barren nor unfruitful in the knowledge of our Lord Jesus Christ.9 For he who lacks these things is shortsighted, even to blindness, and has forgotten that he was cleansed from his old sins.”

It should be noted that [a believer never reaches a point where he has no need to be cautious and to exercise temperance.](#) Titus 2:1-8 (NKJV) *“But as for you, speak the things which are proper for sound doctrine:2 that the older men be sober, reverent, temperate, sound in faith, in love, in patience;3 the older women likewise, that they be reverent in behavior, not slanderers, not given to much wine, teachers of good things—4 that they admonish the young women to love their husbands, to love their children,5 to be discreet, chaste, homemakers, good, obedient to their own husbands, that the word of God may not be blasphemed.6 Likewise exhort the young men to be sober-minded,7 in all things showing yourself to be a pattern of good works; in doctrine showing integrity, reverence, incorruptibility,8 sound speech that cannot be condemned, that one who is an opponent may be ashamed, having nothing evil to say of you.”* Some people think because they have reached a point of advanced years they have the right to say and do anything they choose. This is not so, as we mature in our walk, our responsibility to those who have less experience becomes greater and greater.

These things cannot be attained through the flesh they must be achieved through the Spirit. The fruit of the Spirit is really the nature of God! [The temperate life is 100% God living through us!](#) Galatians 2:20 (NLT) *“I myself no longer live, but Christ lives in me. So I live my life in this earthly body by trusting in the Son of God, who loved me and gave himself for me.”*

We are to walk in such an awareness of God and in such open confession that He is constantly keeping us cleansed from sin. [The forgiveness of God keeps us cleansed, making us pure and acceptable as though we are perfect.](#) Ephesians 5:18 (KJV) *“Be not drunk with wine, wherein is excess; but be filled with the Spirit.”*

[We should walk in such an awareness of God that we assimilate the very nature of God, and the Holy Spirit’s fruit is produced in us on a continual basis.](#)

CONCLUSION:

Notice the special emphasis that the Apostle Paul attaches to these nine components of the fruit of the Spirit. Vs. 23 “.....*Against such there is no law.*”

There is a law against the seventeen works of the flesh! Galatians 5:19-21 (NLT) “*When you follow the desires of your sinful nature, your lives will produce these evil results: sexual immorality, impure thoughts, eagerness for lustful pleasure, 20 idolatry, participation in demonic activities, hostility, quarreling, jealousy, outbursts of anger, selfish ambition, divisions, the feeling that everyone is wrong except those in your own little group, 21 envy, drunkenness, wild parties, and other kinds of sin. Let me tell you again, as I have before, that anyone living that sort of life will not inherit the Kingdom of God.*”

Though there are many laws both Scriptural and civil which condemn the works of the flesh there is no law to condemn these nine components of the fruit of the Spirit. There are many laws to restrain the sinner and his unrighteous deeds but the fruit of the Spirit is encouraged rather than restrained. All of the components of the fruit of the Spirit are in harmony with the requirements of the law rather than running contrary to it. The fruit of the Spirit is manifest through love which is the very fulfillment of the law. As a result, those who are led by the Spirit are not under the law because the person with the components of the fruit of the Spirit active in their life will automatically keep all the law that has not been fulfilled! Galatians 5:16-18 (NLT) “*I advise you to live according to your new life in the Holy Spirit. Then you won’t be doing what your sinful nature craves. 17 The old sinful nature loves to do evil, which is just opposite from what the Holy Spirit wants. And the Spirit gives us desires that are opposite from what the sinful nature desires. These two forces are constantly fighting each other, and your choices are never free from this conflict. 18 But when you are directed by the Holy Spirit, you are no longer subject to the law.”*

(END OF WORKSHEET #10)

